

HACKATHON GUIDE

Find. Build. Explain.

12 September 2026 • VIT Bhopal • Offline

TODAY'S FORMAT You are not being given one fixed problem statement. You are being given a dataset and asked to find a useful problem, pattern, opportunity or question hidden inside it.

01 / WHAT ARE WE DOING TODAY?

Explore the data, identify something meaningful, build a solution around it, and show why your solution is useful.

- You may build a website, dashboard, recommendation tool, map, AI assistant, data-analysis tool, report generator, or something completely different.
- The solution should use the provided data to produce a useful result.
- There is no single correct solution. The four example documents are starting points, not fixed assignments.

02 / YOUR WORKING FLOW

STEP	WHAT TO DO
1. Explore	Open the Starter Kit, read the primer and understand what information is available.
2. Find a question	Ask what useful problem, pattern or decision the data can help with.
3. Build	Start with the smallest useful version of your idea.
4. Improve	Add useful features only after the core idea works.
5. Explain	Show what you built, what the data says and why it matters.

WHAT WILL YOU RECEIVE?

FILE / ITEM	WHAT IT IS FOR
Dataset ZIP	The main data you will analyse and build with.
Corridors_Data_Primer.pdf	A short guide to the concepts and structure of the dataset.
Example 01	Corridor Opportunity Finder — one way to find potential business opportunities.
Example 02	Corridor DNA — one way to turn many data points into a simple corridor profile.
Example 03	Persona → Place Recommender — one way to start with an audience and find relevant corridors.
Example 04	Ask the Corridor Data — one way to let users ask questions and explore the data.
README / supporting files	Additional information about the supplied files and dataset structure.

IMPORTANT The examples are there to help you get started. You can use one, combine ideas, change them, or build something entirely new.

04 / FIRST THINGS TO DO

STEP	DO THIS
1	Unzip the dataset and keep the files together.
2	Open Corridors_Data_Primer.pdf and read it once.
3	Inspect one corridor so you can see what information a record contains.
4	Choose a question you want your product to answer.
5	Build a small first version before adding more features.

05 / WHAT IS IN THE DATA?

The dataset describes commercial corridors in two US regions and connects several kinds of information to each corridor.

AREA	PLAIN-ENGLISH MEANING
Corridor	A named commercial district or walkable area.
Audience	Types of people associated with the corridor.
Activity	Relative activity across different parts of the day.
Places	Real places such as cafés, groceries, schools, hospitals and more.
Business fit	How well a particular business format appears to suit a corridor.
Anchors / special zones	Important activity magnets such as hospitals, campuses, malls and stadiums.

WHAT ARE YOU SUPPOSED TO BUILD?

There is no single correct answer. Start with a useful question and work backwards from it.

EXAMPLES Which corridors could be interesting for a business? | Which corridors are relevant for a particular audience? | Can I compare two corridors? | Can I make the dataset easier to explore?

THE FOUR EXAMPLES

EXAMPLE	CORE QUESTION
01 / Opportunity Finder	Where might a business opportunity be worth investigating?
02 / Corridor DNA	What should I know about this corridor at a glance?
03 / Persona → Place	Where should I look for a particular audience?
04 / Ask the Data	Can a user ask questions and get useful answers from the dataset?

YOU CAN GO BEYOND THESE Combine ideas, simplify them, or create something entirely new. What matters is whether your solution makes good use of the data and produces something useful.

07 / AI + MCP

MCP (Model Context Protocol) is a way for an AI model to use tools or data sources in a structured way. It can be useful when your product needs an AI system to interact with the supplied data.

SIMPLE FLOW	WHAT HAPPENS
User asks	A person asks a question in normal language.
AI understands	The AI identifies the information it needs.
Tools / MCP	The application gets the relevant data.
Your logic	Your program compares or analyses it.
Answer	The user gets a clear result or recommendation.

USE TECHNOLOGY WITH PURPOSE AI or MCP can strengthen a solution when they solve a real part of the problem. You do not need to build a complicated AI agent just to use AI.

08 / KEEP THE FIRST VERSION SMALL

LEVEL	A GOOD FIRST STEP
LEVEL 1	Read data → filter → compare → show a useful result.
LEVEL 2	Add charts, maps, filters, comparisons or better explanations.
LEVEL 3	Add natural-language questions, AI, MCP or more advanced workflows.

WHAT DO YOU NEED TO SUBMIT?

SUBMISSION DEADLINE 2:45 PM • 12 September 2026

Your team submission should contain the following:

SUBMISSION	REQUIREMENT
PPT / Presentation	Your final presentation. Maximum 10 slides. There is no fixed slide structure.
GitHub Repository	A working repository containing your project code.
Demo / Video	Optional. Include one if it helps demonstrate your solution.

10 / YOUR PRESENTATION

You are free to structure your presentation however you think best. The goal is simply to communicate your project clearly within 10 slides or fewer.

- Explain the problem or question you chose.
- Show what you built and how it uses the data.
- Show important results, insights or examples from your solution.
- Use screenshots, diagrams or a demo where they help.
- Keep the story clear: what is the problem, what is your solution, and why is it useful?

POSSIBLE SLIDE TITLES Problem • Approach • Solution • Data Used • How It Works • Demo • Results • Future Scope. These are examples, not requirements.

11 / GITHUB

- Make sure the repository link works.
- Upload the project code before the submission deadline.
- Include a short README explaining what the project does and how to run it.
- Make sure the project is understandable even when a judge opens the repository directly.

HOW WILL YOUR PROJECT BE JUDGED?

Every project will be evaluated out of 100 marks using the same judging criteria.

CRITERIA	MARKS	WHAT JUDGES LOOK FOR
Problem Understanding & Relevance	15	Is the problem clear, meaningful and relevant?
Use of Data & Insights	20	How well is the provided data used, and what useful insights come from it?
Solution Quality & Usefulness	20	Does the solution genuinely help solve the problem or support a user?
Technical Implementation	20	Does it work, and is it implemented in a sensible and effective way?
Innovation / Creativity	10	Is there something thoughtful, creative or different about the approach?
Presentation & Demo	15	How clearly does the team explain and demonstrate the project?
TOTAL	100	

IMPORTANT Complexity alone does not win marks. A simple solution that solves a useful problem well can outperform a much more complicated project that does not.

13 / WHAT JUDGES SHOULD BE ABLE TO UNDERSTAND

- What problem did the team choose?
- Why is it useful?
- How is the provided data being used?
- What did the team actually build?
- What result or insight does the solution produce?

WHAT HAPPENS AFTER SUBMISSION?

TIME / STAGE	WHAT HAPPENS
10:00 AM	Starter Kit and challenge brief released. Teams begin exploring and building.
10:00 AM – 2:30 PM	Ideation, development, testing and preparation. Lunch break is optional; teams may continue working.
2:30 – 2:45 PM	Final submission window. Submit PPT + GitHub link (+ optional demo/video).
2:45 PM onward	Judging begins. Teams are divided between judges.
Final selection	Shortlisted teams are shared with Evam Labs for final selection of the top 3 teams and potential internship opportunities.

15 / BEFORE YOU SUBMIT

CHECK	DONE
Project / prototype is working	☐
Provided data is actually used	☐
Problem and solution are clear	☐
GitHub repository is accessible	☐
README / setup information is included	☐
PPT is 10 slides or fewer	☐
PPT is submitted	☐
GitHub link is submitted	☐
Optional demo/video link added if useful	☐
Everything submitted before 2:45 PM	☐

FINAL REMINDER You are not competing to use the most technologies. You are competing to build something useful, grounded in the data, and explain it clearly.

QUESTION → DATA → SOLUTION → IMPACT

Start with one useful answer. Then build from there.